

Chapter 61-1

The office fell silent.

In front of everyone, Liang Shi turned off the screen, then mouthed to her: "Continue broadcasting—"

Sally sidled up to Liang Shi with a mischievous expression, "May I ask what you felt when you saw that video?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She continued to focus on the computer backend data, thinking about how to make everyone believe she was just tired from staring at the computer too long, rather than having red eyes from jealousy.

"Come on, tell us." Sally bumped her shoulder.

Liang Shi replied expressionlessly, "The editing was quite good."

—Just don't edit it again next time.

Sally chuckled, "If you're jealous, just admit it. You're already married, what's there to be afraid of?"

Liang Shi rubbed her forehead helplessly, "It's just a CP fan video, it's not real."

Sally stared at her, her eyes full of—I don't believe you.

Shortly after, Sally said: "Leo, if I were you, I'd definitely go up and kiss her, with a French kiss to boot, declaring ownership to everyone. You didn't see those comments—everyone watching Blanche has gone crazy. Declaring ownership might be childish, but it's still very necessary, especially when your wife is this beautiful and attractive."

Sally's voice wasn't loud, but everyone in the office could hear.

She was originally just teasing Liang Shi and didn't avoid others.

But unexpectedly, after she finished speaking, Lin Luoxi came over and gave her a smack on the back, "Will you die if you don't speak?"

Sally gasped, "Just joking around."

"Heh." Lin Luoxi sneered, "The whole internet knows now."

Sally: "???"

Liang Shi was even more shocked, opening the Weibo livestream page to find everyone commenting in the same direction:

[So Xu Zong's wife is right there in the office? How exciting.]

[If the third Miss Liang is good-looking, I wouldn't mind watching a French kiss either.]

[@Third Miss Liang, come out and declare your ownership.]

[@Third Miss Liang, are you scared?]

[What bad intentions could I have? I just want to see pretty sisters kissing and hugging.]

[.....]

The topic was like a runaway horse, beginning to gallop wildly.

The reason was that Xu Qingzhu's side had limited equipment, so the laptop was open, and conversations in the office could be heard.

At first, when Sally was being restrained, Xu Qingzhu was also talking, so netizens couldn't hear her voice.

But later Sally's voice became louder, and with Xu Qingzhu and Yang Shuyan falling silent, what the microphone picked up was naturally Sally's voice.

However, Sally spoke in English, so the comments were initially very confused.

Unfortunately, there were English experts who translated, so Sally's words were embellished and told to the netizens.

Now the entire internet knew that Xu Zong's wife was right there, and she had even gotten red eyes from watching the CP fan video of Xu Zong with Yang Shuyan.

Being jealous to this extent was ridiculous!

Everyone went from mentioning the third Miss Liang to shipping the real-life couple.

[When watching the video just now, Xu Zong didn't blush, but now her ears are about to drip blood from how red they are.]

[I think we can ship this, just don't know if the third Miss Liang is pretty or not.]

[Are there no photos? Don't tell me no one can dig them up? I don't believe it!]

[A real married couple is the sweetest! What need is there for photos! Even without photos I can ship them!]

[The person above is right, I'm already imagining how Xu Zong will coax Miss Liang when she goes home tonight.]

[A CEO during the day, lying in bed acting cute at night.]

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Xu Qingzhu really couldn't bear to look at the comments anymore and turned off the livestream.

After turning off the livestream, she finally breathed a sigh of relief. Lin Luoxi handed her water, "This thrilling day is finally over."

"Yes." Xu Qingzhu smiled upon hearing this, "It feels like it lasted forever."

From nervously waiting for new product sales at the beginning, to the online public opinion piling up, seeing the flood of negative comments.

Every minute and second passed exceptionally slowly.

Especially when waiting to counterattack.

Xu Qingzhu might be able to wait for other things, but when someone wronged her, she absolutely couldn't wait.

She would definitely be the first to reveal all her cards.

But Liang Shi made her wait.

And laid out the entire strategy for her.

This was a very successful public relations case.

Chapter 61-2

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After she finished the livestream, it was already 11 PM.

Both Minghui Jewelry's online orders and offline orders were being compiled, with total pre-orders exceeding expectations by more than twenty times.

This made Xu Qingzhu feel exceptionally reassured.

Through this battle, Minghui Jewelry had finally welcomed the beginning of its upward trajectory.

The public relations departments of both companies looked at Liang Shi with indescribable expressions.

The reason they could become department heads at major companies wasn't just because of their high academic qualifications, but because they had been battle-tested in the PR industry, handling countless PR cases and successfully resolving most PR crises.

So when dealing with PR crises, they had independent PR systems and processes. Following these methods would definitely prevent mistakes.

But today, someone who could be called a complete PR outsider had not only avoided mistakes, but had achieved what could be called a perfect PR case.

Firmly grasping the evidence, luring the snake out of its hole, waiting for the perfect moment, and striking decisively.

From the evidence chain to timing, including driving traffic to their own company, every link was flawless.

A textbook-level PR approach.

However, Liang Shi didn't think that much. She closed all the backend web pages that were running, then shut her laptop and rubbed her eyes. She had been staring at data all day, and her eyes were dry and sore.

Looking up, she saw the two PR department heads staring at her. Liang Shi was puzzled, "What's wrong?"

It was Minghui's PR head who swallowed his pride and hesitantly asked: "Miss Liang, did you study marketing?"

"Huh?" Liang Shi was surprised: "No, I studied Chinese Language and Literature."

In reality, she was someone who couldn't afford college due to poverty and never got the chance to study.

Speaking of it was always a regret.

Actually, her grades were very good back then, but her grandparents' sudden deaths made her mood extremely terrible.

Without any source of income, she was too thin-skinned to ask teachers for money, so she went straight to work.

Only after experiencing society did she realize that studying was relatively one of the easier paths in this world.

Because you only needed to focus on your grades.

Liang Shi briefly thought about the past, then snapped back to attention, showing a polite smile, "What's wrong?"

The department head was stunned, then told the truth: "Because your handling method was too mature, I thought you had learned from masters, but it turns out you're self-taught. I admire that."

"It's not really self-taught." Liang Shi said.

The department head: "?"

"A few days ago when organizing magazine documents, I read a few books on marketing and PR." Liang Shi said.

She wasn't lying either - she had read those books.

But they weren't very useful.

Just like students can learn as much as they want from textbooks, no matter how fancy, they still need to selectively apply it to reality.

Otherwise, it's just waste paper.

Even if you work in a related industry, you might not necessarily be able to use that knowledge.

Textbooks are just the tip of the iceberg of an industry.

What Liang Shi had came from learning in society.

She stood on the shoulders of giants.

But she couldn't tell them this, so she'd let these two department heads think she was a self-taught genius.

Although this would deal a crushing blow to the two department heads.

Sure enough, after hearing her words, the department head's expression became even more indescribable, and he could only let out a long sigh.

Liang Xinhe glanced at Dongheng's PR department head Wu Sheng, who had made snide remarks when Liang Shi proposed suggestions, but now Liang Shi had proven with actions that her plan was the best.

Wu Sheng was incredulous.

Liang Xinhe then called him out: "Director Wu, how do you think this PR campaign went?"

The named Wu Sheng: "Huh?"

He was stunned, then said: "Very perfect."

These four words could only be applied to very few PR campaigns.

After all, in the PR industry, you need keen insight, control over timing, and so much more. It's hard for anyone to dare say their PR campaign was perfect.

Because if someone else were to do it, there might be an even more perfect solution.

But what Liang Shi proposed this time could indeed be called perfect.

Using the opponent's character flaws, giving them no chance and hammering them to death.

She could also layout everything in the process, guiding everything toward a favorable direction.

Without ten years of online research, you couldn't make such precise judgments.

Liang Xinhe glanced at Wu Sheng, his tone light: "Director Wu, I think that there are always people better than us, and there's always a higher mountain. People shouldn't be too arrogant, don't you think?"

Director Wu: "....."

He was left red-faced by the comment.

"Some people are just naturally smart, able to draw inferences and make connections." Liang Xinhe raised an eyebrow, "You can't forget she's originally a tiger just because she's been acting like a cat for a few years, right? Moreover, I think people need to courageously acknowledge their shortcomings to improve better, don't you think?"

Director Wu: "....."

Every "don't you think" was clearly meant to make him realize his mistake.

Director Wu's face heated up, but he still sincerely apologized to Liang Shi: "Third Miss, I'm sorry. My perspective was too narrow."

"It's fine, it's fine." Liang Shi immediately said.

As she spoke, she looked at Liang Xinhe, feeling he was being too harsh on an elderly employee who had worked at Dongheng for decades.

But Liang Xinhe didn't think so - he raised his chin, looking quite proud.

Liang Shi: "....."

After this battle was fought, everyone was physically and mentally exhausted.

Liang Shi very politely thanked each person, then saw everyone off one by one.

Even to Zhou Yi'an, she expressed her gratitude.

Zhou Yi'an looked at her and left without saying a word.

Finally, only she and Xu Qingzhu remained.

The two stood in front of Minghui Jewelry's office building. It was nearly midnight, and everything was quiet.

The office building was already shrouded in darkness.

Chapter 61-3

Xu Qingzhu let out a heavy breath, closing her eyes to feel the temperature of the wind.

Liang Shi turned her face to look at her.

Her hair tie was loose, and by now it had almost all come undone, with the edges of her hair blown messy by the wind. The line of her neck was beautiful and smooth, her earlobes flushed red, her face radiating a happy and satisfied smile.

The autumn night was cold, and the coat she wore was thin, making her shiver from the cold.

Even so, she was still smiling.

Liang Shi asked her: "Aren't you cold?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "My heart is warm."

Because so many people were helping her, and when she was in difficulty, Liang Shi walked into that office.

And told her, "It's okay."

It was an indescribable sense of security.

Then, the matter was perfectly resolved.

She used the most upright means, standing on the opponent's platform, to hammer them into darkness.

This was something she had never imagined possible.

The corners of Xu Qingzhu's mouth lifted, and she sniffled, asking: "Teacher Liang, are you cold?"

Her voice already carried a nasal tone when she spoke.

"I'm alright." Liang Shi took off her own coat and draped it directly on her, "You're about to catch a cold."

"I won't." Xu Qingzhu said, and the coat was already about to fall off.

Liang Shi hadn't dared to get too close to her, so she had just loosely draped the coat over her shoulders. But she didn't expect that with one movement, the coat would almost fall. Fortunately, Liang Shi was quick, her hand landing on the coat and pressing it against her back, catching the coat.

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This posture was somewhat awkward.

Originally just trying to catch a coat, but unexpectedly it turned into a half-embrace.

Liang Shi stood at Xu Qingzhu's side, her body blocking half the wind in front of Xu Qingzhu, her arm bent, just in an embracing position.

The warm breath that Xu Qingzhu exhaled blew against Liang Shi's ear.

Together with the wind, it gently brushed past, making Liang Shi's ear itch, and she very uncontrollably swallowed.

"Gulp—"

This sound was especially clear in the quiet night.

Xu Qingzhu suddenly laughed out loud, and Liang Shi felt thoroughly embarrassed.

When she laughed, she lowered her head, her head just a little bit away from resting on Liang Shi's chest, and Liang Shi could actually feel the trembling of her body.

"Teacher Liang." Xu Qingzhu asked: "Haven't you got hold of the clothes yet?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She immediately withdrew her hand, though her movements were a bit flustered, and so... the clothes fell and she grabbed them, grabbed them and they fell again.

Her hands were incredibly clumsy at this moment, not knowing what to do, yet time and again touching Xu Qingzhu's back.

From shoulder to lower back.

Xu Qingzhu didn't say anything.

Finally.....

Liang Shi grabbed hold of the coat, then unfolded it and stood directly in front of Xu Qingzhu, putting it on her.

But her hair was too much in the way, and the hair tie was already precarious, about to fall off.

Liang Shi simply pulled her hair out, and the black hair tie made a turn and ended up on Liang Shi's wrist.

Her hair fell loose, dancing in the wind. Liang Shi returned the hair tie to her, "Tie it up yourself."

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "It's cold."

Her hands retracted into her sleeves, too lazy to take them out.

Liang Shi really couldn't bear to watch, and said gently: "Then shall I tie it for you?"

"Okay." Xu Qingzhu sniffled again, her originally cool voice turned into a soft baby voice because of the cold weather when she spoke, "Thank you, Teacher Liang."

Liang Shi: "....."

This was the first time hearing Xu Qingzhu speak with this kind of voice.

Combined with her cold and beautiful face, it created an especially strong contrast.

Liang Shi was slightly taller than her, standing in front of her to block the wind. She originally wanted to go behind to tie her hair, but before she could move, Xu Qingzhu grabbed her.

Her not-so-soft baby voice said: "Cold."

Liang Shi: "....."

Who just said their heart was warm?

Liang Shi didn't bicker with her over this - talking too much would just fill her stomach with cold wind. She simply resigned herself to doing as she wished.

Standing directly in front of her, she smoothed her long hair from top to bottom, then wound it three times. It was slightly tight, so Liang Shi reached to adjust it downward, but ended up breaking one of her hairs, which fell right into her palm.

Chapter 61-4

Liang Shi felt a bit embarrassed to show Xu Qingzhu that strand of hair.

Xu Qingzhu glanced up at her, "Secretly keeping my hair?"

"It was an accident." Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu: "I don't care, then you have to compensate me with one of yours."

Saying this, she stood on tiptoe and leaned over, reaching out her hand and plucking one of her hairs.

Liang Shi: "....."

Isn't this childish?

Besides, wasn't she just complaining about being cold when tying her hair?

Liang Shi was helpless.

But when Xu Qingzhu leaned over, her lips were only a centimeter from her neck, and her hand reached around from the other side.

It looked exactly like an embrace.

Then—a sharp pain came from the back of her head.

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The pain drove away all of Liang Shi's romantic thoughts.

But after Xu Qingzhu plucked one of her hairs, she placed both strands in her palm, illuminated together by the streetlight.

"I heard that in the past, people would tie their hair together on their wedding night, so they wouldn't be separated." Xu Qingzhu suddenly said: "Teacher Liang, do you think this is true or false?"

"I don't know." Liang Shi said: "It seems like it's just for a beautiful meaning."

As soon as she finished speaking, a gust of wind blew, and the hairs in both their palms were blown away.

Liang Shi suppressed a laugh, "Now we're really even."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her sideways and retracted her hands again.

An unspoken silence fell between them.

As if they were together enjoying the calm after the storm.

Even though the wind was cold, when it blew on them it even felt gentle.

Much better than being on edge all day long.

After an unknown period of silence, Xu Qingzhu was the first to speak: "Liang Shi, have you experienced a lot before?"

Liang Shi was spacing out, looking at a cat nestled in the grass by the roadside.

Hearing this, she turned her head back, responding in surprise: "Hm?"

"Have you experienced many things like today?" Xu Qingzhu asked again.

Her voice was very soft, making Liang Shi's response gentle as well: "Not too many."

Liang Shi said: "I can only say that someone taught me a lot."

"Then when you see comments like today's, do you feel sad?" Xu Qingzhu asked: "Those floods of negative comments, wishing your whole family dead."

Liang Shi smiled, "You're still thinking about those? Don't think about it anymore. They're just talking online, sometimes it's just pure emotional venting. There's no need to take it to heart."

"I'm asking if you've experienced it." Xu Qingzhu said: "Being cursed at so wantonly like this, being constantly hurt by people's words."

Liang Shi's smile froze, and she suddenly fell silent.

After the silence, she smiled gently, "As long as you don't look, it doesn't matter."

She kept evading the questions Xu Qingzhu threw at her, but every indirect answer was saying: Yes, I've been cursed at like this.

Xu Qingzhu stared at her, not knowing if it was from the wind or being infected by the atmosphere, but her eyes were actually glistening.

Xu Qingzhu's voice carried a few notes of grievance, "Teacher Liang, why did they curse at you before?"

"Bad acting." Liang Shi said: "At the beginning, I didn't know anything, so being cursed at was normal. And also....."

Liang Shi smiled bitterly, memories suddenly returning to before she left that world, when everyone was cursing at her. Even if she didn't open her computer, news would still push through.

And many people would camp outside her home, go to her workplace.

—You dead pervert!

—Stop clinging to Sun Chengcheng!

—Shipping a CP just from filming one yuri drama! Shameless!

.....

Liang Shi paused, then made her voice even softer and calmer. She said in a low voice: "Just some very minor issues, but... becoming a public figure means you'll be cursed at. Just act like you didn't see it. After all, it's impossible to make everyone satisfied, right?"

She lowered her head to look at Xu Qingzhu, only to see tears falling from Xu Qingzhu's eyes.

The kind that hung directly on her eyelashes.

Liang Shi panicked and quickly searched for a tissue, coaxing in a low voice: "We're just discussing something, why are you crying?"

Xu Qingzhu didn't speak.

Liang Shi unwrapped the tissue, folded it, bent down, and carefully wiped away the tears hanging on Xu Qingzhu's eyelashes.

Liang Shi thought she was sad about the negative comments she'd suffered during the day, thinking this little princess had never experienced such grievances and was probably at her breaking point now.

She sighed inwardly, feeling the little princess had experienced too little, but couldn't help gently coaxing: "It's okay, it's all in the past. No matter what they do, they're just behind a screen. If you don't want to look, it's fine. Besides, those people all bought things from your company, you made money from them, right?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "No....."

Her cool voice carried a baby tone that wasn't too obvious, but with the sob, it seemed even more aggrieved.

"Then what's wrong?" Liang Shi asked, coaxing like she would a child.

Xu Qingzhu suddenly lifted her head, rested it on her shoulder, and reached out her arms to hug her.

Liang Shi's body stiffened.

Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes, buried her head in her embrace, and said in a muffled voice: "Liang Shi, don't go into the entertainment industry, okay?"

The burning heat of her tears scalded Liang Shi's heart.